

ABOUT WNS

WE ARE WORKERS IN NEW MEXICO STRIVING TO:

END US LEADERSHIP AND PARTICIPATION IN INTERNATIONAL WAR IN ALL ITS DIMENSIONS: POLITICAL, ECONOMIC, CULTURAL, AND MILITARY

BUILD A THRIVING ECONOMY IN THE UNITED STATES BASED ON PEACEFUL, SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT, CULTURAL PRODUCTION, REINDUSTRIALIZATION WHERE NECESSARY, AND TECHNOLOGY LEVERAGED TO SUPPORT A HIGH QUALITY, DIGNIFIED LIFE FOR ALL PEOPLE

CREATE A ROBUST DEMOCRATIC SYSTEM IN THE UNITED STATES THAT AFFORDS SELF-DETERMINATION FOR THE PEOPLE, AND AN EFFICIENT, FUNCTIONAL, AND RESPONSIVE GOVERNMENT



CONTACT US:

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READ OUR SUBSTACK:

[HTTPS://WORKERSFORANEWSOUTHWEST.SUBSTACK.COM](https://workersforanewsouthwest.substack.com)

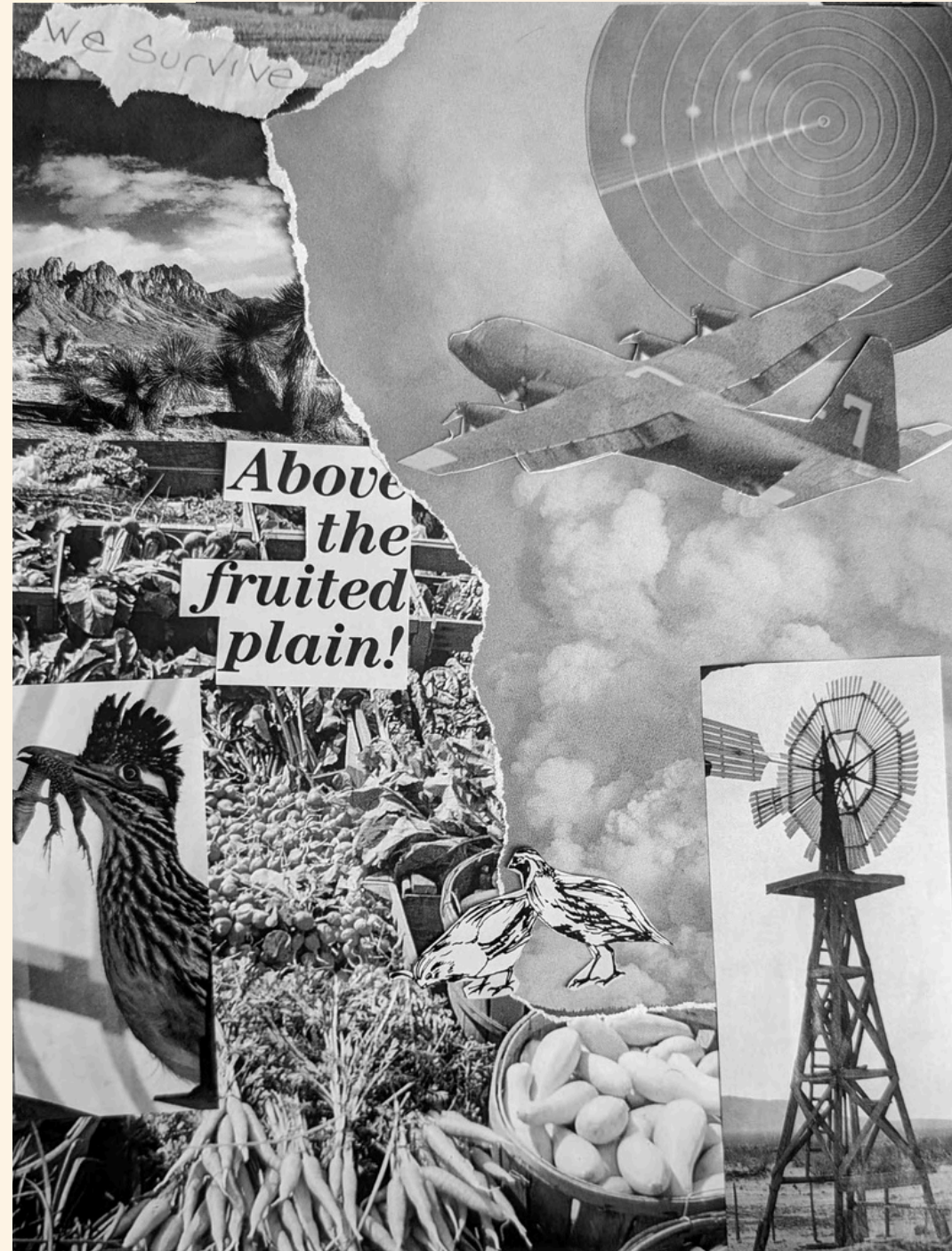
WRITE FOR WNS:

[HTTPS://WNS-WRITERS-PORTAL.NETLIFY.APP](https://wns-writers-portal.netlify.app)



SEEDING A NEW FUTURE:

BLOOMING AWAY FROM THE WAR ECONOMY



What if the green chile cheeseburger you ate for lunch had beef raised by the Valencia County Ranching Cooperative, where thousands of acres of land were managed for ecosystem health while providing clean meat for New Mexico.

And what if the bun came from wheat grown by Navajo Agricultural Products Industry — free of glyphosate and other toxic herbicides — and was baked by kids at the culinary trade high school in downtown Albuquerque.

The chile from well-paid farmers in the south, who have legal priority in water use before data centers, boutique pecan farms, and golf courses.

What if the enormous rangeland where White Sands Missile Range sits was used for rearing bison, for game management, for seeing the stars with your family.

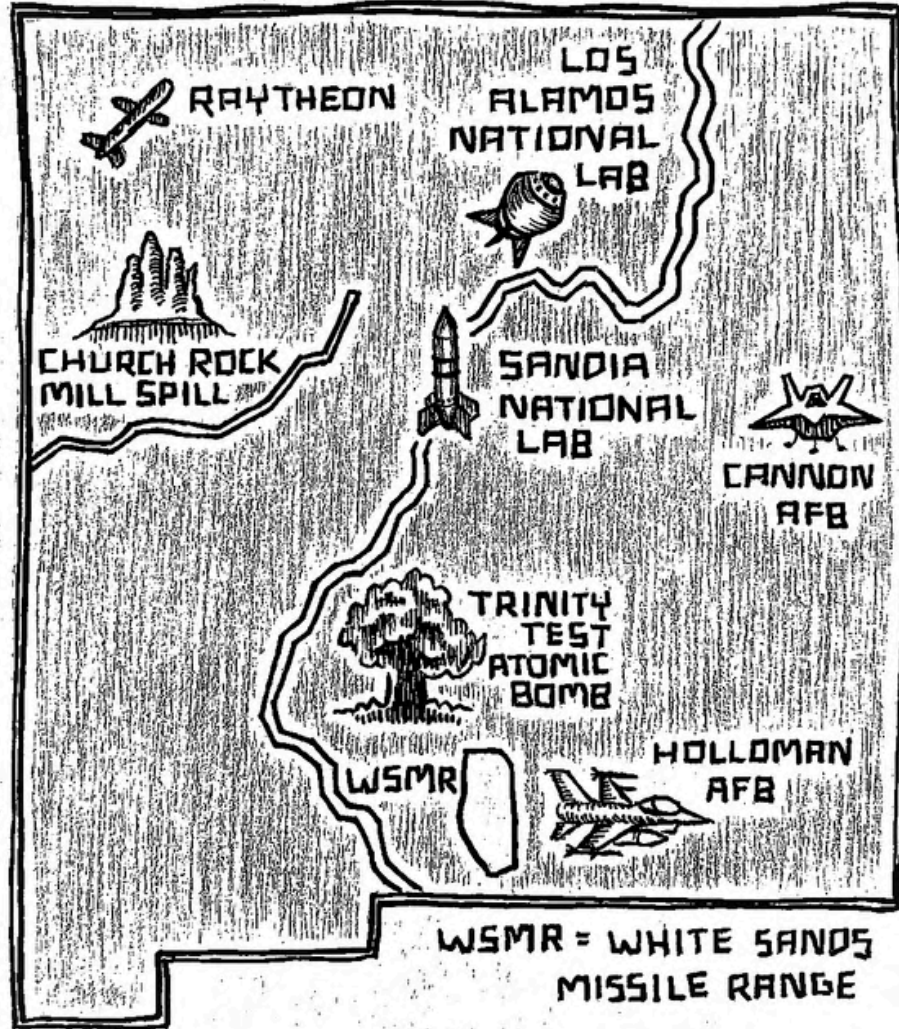
What if the economic base of our state rested on good jobs working the land, feeding and housing each other, and taking care of our young, our sick, and our elders. Instead of weapons development, surveillance warehouses, and training our youth to kill people halfway around the world.

We in New Mexico live amidst a massive architecture of death machines. But within this state — within ourselves — we contain the seeds of a bountiful, dignified, peaceful, and beautiful future.



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WAR AT HOME IN NEW MEXICO



FURTHER READING

- lasg.org → Los Alamos Study Group homepage. They provide data and analysis on nuclear weapons developments in New Mexico.
- <https://elainecimino652909.substack.com/> → Elaine Cimino reports on the developing advanced weapon systems industry in New Mexico.

ALL OF THESE FUTURES ARE POSSIBLE...BUT LET'S LOOK AT OUR CURRENT CONDITIONS

New Mexico's development as a pivotal part of the US war machine began with the establishment of the Manhattan Project at the Los Alamos National Laboratory (LANL). Since then, the Federal government has used our state as a weapons lab and dumping ground for the waste associated with nuclear testing and armament production. Let's look at some examples:

- The Trinity test — on July 16, 1945, the US detonated the first nuclear weapon in history in the Tularosa Basin. In 2010, the CDC determined that people's radiation exposure rates from the Trinity detonation were 10,000 times higher than allowable levels.
- The Church Rock uranium mill spill — on July 16, 1979, 94 million gallons of radioactive waste spilled into the Puerco River, flowing through nearby communities. Radioactive elements have been found in people's homes and drinking water sources in these areas for decades. Much of the uranium mined was for nuclear weapons production at LANL.
- PFAS contamination — in 2018, runoff from Cannon Air Force Base contaminated water sources with PFAS, forcing dairy farmers to euthanize thousands of their cows. Additionally, wastewater from Holloman Air Force Base has created the single most PFAS-contaminated body of water ever measured in the world to date.

OUR TAX DOLLARS SPENT ON WAR INSTEAD OF PUBLIC GOODS

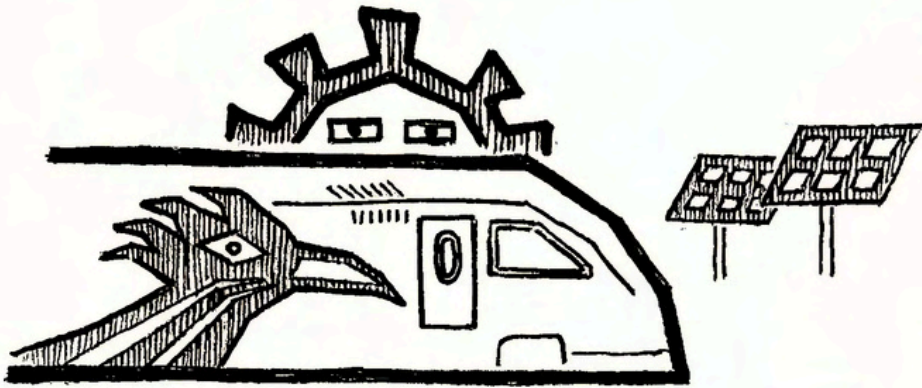
The war industry in New Mexico not only poisons our land and people but is also responsible for atrocities committed by the US military in sovereign countries around the world – for the benefit of arms dealers, at the expense of US taxpayers, and at the cost of thousands of lives:

- White Sands Missile Range (where the Trinity test took place) is a massive weapons testing installation in central NM about the size of Delaware and Rhode Island combined. Some of the weapons tested there include the **Massive Ordnance Penetrator bombs used to attack civilian infrastructure in Iran in June 2025. These bombs cost around \$3.5 million to manufacture. With \$3.5 million, we could pay for the annual salary of approximately 54 teachers in New Mexico.** How many of these bombs are being manufactured for testing and use annually? How many more teachers could we have in our public education system with this money?
- Raytheon operates a missile component manufacturing plant on the Navajo Nation near Farmington, where they generate parts for 12 missile programs including the Tomahawk cruise missile. **Two Tomahawk missiles were used to destroy an elementary school in Minab, Iran in March 2026, killing over 150 school children and staff.** These missiles cost around \$2.2 million each. The ART bus' annual budget for operations and maintenance is \$2.4 million. What could our public transit options look like if we stopped building missiles and started building bus infrastructure?

WHAT DOES A PEACE ECONOMY IN NEW MEXICO LOOK LIKE TO YOU? SKETCH, BRAINSTORM, AND DREAM BELOW!

WHAT IT COULD BE...OUR VISION FOR A PEACE ECONOMY

The Railrunner could be powered by solar energy, efficiently connecting the Southwest and decreasing our reliance on cars and interstates. Buses could come frequently with routes that cover everyone's needs in the city. We could improve our infrastructure to facilitate walking and biking safely.



We could provide free access to adequate healthcare to everyone in our state. We could render private insurance companies irrelevant, no longer allowing CEOs to extract rent from our health and well-being.

Our neighbors wouldn't have to sacrifice their morals to build weapons. **People wouldn't need to do work in the war industry to put a roof over their heads when we have an economy that prioritizes well-being and interdependence.** Instead, they could apply their skills to creating resilient and relational communities. We could live in relationship with the land and the water and one another, rather than in a transaction of extraction and contamination.

We have all of the necessary skills and resources to begin building this world tomorrow — the piece that is missing is **reclaiming the political power that we hold as the masses** to restructure our economic priorities away from CEOs' pocketbooks back into public goods. **We make this state run** — from the coffee servers to the utility workers to the teachers to the landscapers, from the ranchers to the chile pickers to the nurses to the janitors. Together we can build a **peace economy**.

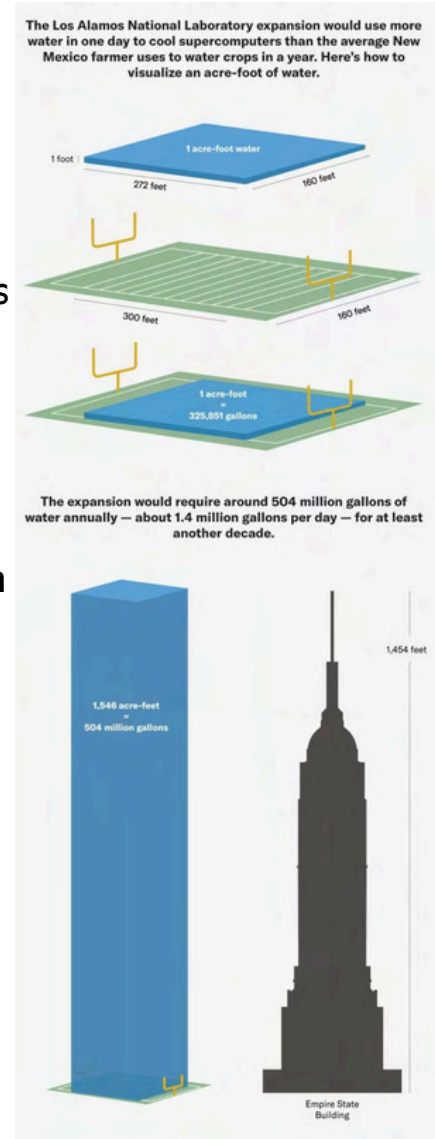
THE WAR INDUSTRY CONTINUES TO EXPAND IN NEW MEXICO AS OUR GOVERNMENT CONTINUES TO INVEST IN WAR

LANL is undergoing its biggest expansion since World War II to increase its production and delivery of plutonium nuclear bomb cores, known as pits. This will require an enormous use of resources, including one that has felt exceptionally scarce this summer — water.

The Department of Energy has projected that the expansion would require around **504 million gallons of water annually** — about **1.4 million gallons of water per day**.

The expanded lab would use **more water in one day than the average farmer uses in a single year**.

How much food could be grown with this water instead? How many people's hunger and thirst could be eased? We cannot eat nuclear bombs nor the devastation they promise.



Luna Anna Archey / High Country News

WORKING PEOPLE IN NEW MEXICO ARE PAYING THE COST

In New Mexico, over 350,000 residents, including nearly one in four children, live in food insecure households, with the state ranking **fourth in the nation for high rates of food insecurity**. **79% of households in Bernalillo County are located in a food desert**, where access to fresh, healthy foods is severely limited.

People in food insecure households are much more likely to have **hypertension, diabetes, heart disease, and other chronic health problems**. **Heart disease is consistently the number one cause of death in NM.**

These are the harsh realities of our current war economy, but it is possible for things to be different. In order for things to change, we must understand that the war industry is hurting New Mexicans and people across the globe. We must divest from war and invest in human and planetary needs. We must do away with the war economy, and build a peace economy before it's too late.

WHAT IT COULD BE...OUR VISION FOR A PEACE ECONOMY

A peace economy in New Mexico must be multi-faceted. First and foremost, it must be developed in direct response to how deeply entangled we are in the war economy. **It involves divesting from war and redirecting our work by investing in human and ecological wellbeing.** We must build relationships and communities that have the capacity to show up for one another — tomorrow, as well as generations from now.

This means taking state and federal funds away from weapons manufacturing, testing, and research, and out of military contracts and installations in the pursuit of profit. Instead, we must place our efforts, skills, and resources into an economy that prioritizes human development, satisfies the needs of society, and facilitates cooperation and relationship with each other and with our land and water.

We envision a robust public education system, reliable public transit, safe and accessible pedestrian infrastructure, renewable energy, water resilience in the high desert, protection and recovery from wildfires, and cleaning up contaminants. **Our soil can be used to grow food and grow communities, rather than becoming a grounds for destruction and a vessel for poisoning our people.** We can replace competition with cooperation and community networks that are directed towards **growing life with high quality, not destroying life in high quantity.**

